

STEM ANIMATION

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ Portfolio was submitted prior to conference
- ☐ Animation was submitted prior to conference
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Digital Portfolio (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Purpose and Description (X1)	The purpose and description of the animation idea are unclear.	The purpose and description of the animation are explained appropriately.	The purpose and description of the animation are clear and concisely written.	
Storyboard (X1)	The hand-sketched storyboard is sloppy, seems to have been thrown together after the creation of the animation, and/or it does not correlate with the animation.	The storyboard is drawn appropriately and largely correlates with the completed animation.	The storyboard is of exceptional aesthetic and artistic value and clearly correlates with the animation.	
Work Log (X1)	Log is poorly organized and/or incomplete.	Log is adequately detailed and organized and contains most of the required components.	Log is well documented and contains all the required components.	
DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (40 points)				

ANIMATION (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Communication of Animation (X1)	It is difficult to understand the idea being communicated; an illogical explanation is presented.	The idea is communicated, and thoughts are somewhat organized and/or concise.	The idea is communicated in an organized, clear, and concise manner.	
Creativity (X1)	The animation lacks creativity; no, or very few, design principles are integrated in the animation.	Some elements of creativity are expressed, and essential design principles are used somewhat effectively.	The animation exudes creativity; essential design principles and elements are integrated.	

ANIMATION (50 points) – continued				
Aesthetics and Artisanship (X1)	Unorganized, sloppy work is evident; the animation seems to be an afterthought and/or thrown together.	An organized presentation of essential issues in a logical format is evident.	An exemplary use of layout and design principles to logically communicate important data is evident.	
Graphical Representations (X1)	Graphical representations do not help to clarify the idea, or they are of little significance to the idea.	Graphical representations are appropriate and help supplement the idea by providing some clarity.	Graphical representations are of excellent quality and completely clarify the idea.	
Originality (X1)	The animation lacks imagination, originality, and artistic detail.	The animation is effective and innovative, conveying some depth.	The animation is inspiring, inventive, resourceful, and completely motivating.	
ANIMATION SUBTOTAL (50 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____	
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TIME DEDUCTIONS	
A three (3)-point deduction will be incurred for each fifteen (15) seconds, or fraction thereof, over the three (3)-minute animation maximum length.	
TOTAL ANIMATION TIME	
NUMBER OF TIME INTERVAL DEDUCTIONS	
TOTAL TIME DEDUCTIONS	

Record scores in the column spaces below.

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (90 points)	
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SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION (60 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Organization (X1)	Participants seem unorganized and unprepared for the presentation; illogical explanation of the idea is presented.	Participants are generally prepared for the presentation; an explanation of idea is communicated and generally organized.	The presentation is logical, well organized, and easy to follow; the idea is communicated in an organized and concise manner.	
Articulation (X1)	The presentation is full of illogical thoughts that lack clarity, and/or there is insufficient information provided describing the project.	The presentation is somewhat logical, easy to follow, and/or there is sufficient information provided describing the project.	The presentation is clear, concise, and there is ample information provided describing the project.	

SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION (60 points) – continued			
Delivery (X1)	The team is verbose and/or uncertain in its presentation; participants' posture, gestures, and lack of eye contact diminish the presentation.	The team is somewhat well-spoken and clear in its presentation; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact are acceptable in the presentation.	The team is well-spoken and distinct in its presentation; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact result in a polished, natural, and effective presentation.
Knowledge (X2)	Participants seem to have little understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participants exhibit an understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participants show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of their project.
Team Participation (X1)	The majority of the delivery is made by one member of the team; the partner may be disengaged from the presentation.	Both team members generally are engaged in the process, though one member may take on more responsibility than the other.	Both team members are actively involved in the presentation and responses to any questions; there is shared responsibility between team members.
SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION SUBTOTAL (60 points)			
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____			
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (60 points)			
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (150 points)			

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____